PRIORITY 1 OF 33 · SCORE 4.8

Health and Human Services

HHS is where the money and the data meet. Medicare and Medicaid had about $90B in FY2025 improper payments, and CMS publishes provider-level billing, enrollment and ownership data that let us score individual providers. Start with hospice and home health, which CMS froze to new Medicare enrollment in May 2026 and DOJ named as whistleblower priorities.

INVESTIGATIONS WE PROPOSE

HHS-1 Hospice and home health clusters: shared addresses and owners, billing ramp after enrollment, long stays and live discharges. **First prototype.** One-page pitch available.

HHS-2 Owner networks linked to LEIE exclusions, revoked and suspended providers.

HHS-3 National billing outliers in durable medical equipment, labs and telehealth.

EXPOSURE

- Medicaid: $37.4B improper (6.1%). Medicare fee-for-service: $28.8B (6.6%). Medicare Advantage: $23.7B (6.1%). Head Start: 10.3% rate. (GAO, FY2025)
- CMS imposed a six-month nationwide moratorium on new hospice and home health enrollments on 2026-05-13, citing sham hospices and patients who were not terminally ill.
- Payment suspensions hit about 800 Los Angeles hospices and home health agencies; HHS froze federal child care payments to Minnesota in Dec 2025.

PUBLIC DATA WE USE

- **Medicare Provider Utilization and Payment** (by provider and service), Part D prescribers, and the hospice and home health provider files.
- **Provider ownership data** for hospices, home health agencies and nursing homes (owners, ownership changes, shared owners).
- **NPPES** (NPI registry: addresses, taxonomies, enumeration dates).
- **HHS-OIG LEIE** exclusion list and **Open Payments**.
- **DOJ and HHS-OIG enforcement releases** as labeled examples.
- Head Start and child care grants on **USAspending**.

SCORECARD

Fraud savings identified
● Pending

Phase 1 window
Weeks 3–7
Nov 16, 2026 to Dec 18, 2026

Workstream
Wave 1 and Wave 2 deep dives

FY2026 outlays
$2.69T · budget rank 1

Leads go to
CMS CPI, HHS-OIG, DOJ HCF Unit

WHY PRIORITY 1

Exposure	●●●●●
Public data	●●●●●
SBA method fit	●●●●○
Actionability	●●●●●

TOOL PREVIEW

Hospice and home health risk map. See the wireframe of the screen HHS would receive.

On the site: Tool previews, HHS hospice risk map.

HOW WE DETECT IT

1. **Hospice and home health clusters:** many new providers at shared addresses or with shared owners, fast billing ramp after enrollment, unusually long stays or live-discharge rates versus peers.
2. **Ownership networks:** owners or managers linked to LEIE-excluded parties or to providers already suspended; serial ownership changes.
3. **Outlier billing:** providers far above peers in services per patient, new high-cost codes, or patterns matching past DOJ cases (for example COVID and respiratory test billing).

FIRST PROTOTYPE

A hospice and home health risk map for two hot spots (Los Angeles County and Minnesota). Each provider gets a score with the reasons behind it, and the view shows the owner network. Validate against providers already suspended or charged.

OUR REVIEW, DELIVERED WEEK 7

Risk map and ranked list for the two hot spots; owner network view; national outlier table; review memo; lead packages for the top networks.

Every lead goes to an Inspector General or DOJ as a referral package with sources and caveats. Nothing is published.

WHAT WE ASK OF HHS

Phase 2 data: Medicare claims, Medicaid T-MSIS claims, enrollment applications, PECOS, MA encounter data.

What it enables: Claim-level scoring; impossible-day and phantom-patient tests; MA risk-adjustment upcoding; patient recruitment rings.

Access route: HHS-OIG; CMS Center for Program Integrity; CMS research data (VRDC) for analysis.

LIMITS

Public files lag 1 to 2 years and are aggregated (small counts suppressed). Medicaid claims are state-run and not public, so Medicaid work starts from provider enrollment and ownership, not claims.

SOURCES

- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments
- WilmerHale: CMS hospice and home health moratorium (May 2026)
- NBC: Minnesota child care findings and HHS payment freeze
- DOJ whistleblower program priority areas

Scores and plans are our judgment from public sources. Risk indicators are leads for Inspectors General or DOJ, not accusations.

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